

below should help you avoid most problems, but you should feel free to experiment and fine tune them to fit your needs.

End of Each Chapter

At the end of each game session, or chapter, you should award the characters between one and five experience points. One point is awarded automatically, simply because the character experienced the chapter's events. Despite ourselves, we tend to learn from the follies of others as we do from our own.

One Point — Automatic: Each player gets one point at the end of each chapter.

One Point — Learning Curve: Ask the player what his character learned in the course of the night's events. If you agree with the answer, give the player one experience point.

One Point — Roleplaying: The player carried out the role of her character well, not only entertainingly but appropriately. The player performed as the character should in the circumstances. Truly inspired roleplaying might merit two experience points.

One Point — Heroism: Changeling is a game of heroism, of holding fast to ideals and vows in the face temptation or, worse, Banality. Changelings risk all to let friends or Dreamers escape from disaster or death. If a character acts heroically and manages to survive, he should be rewarded. Some players might try to take advantage of this idea. Don't let them. Stupidity and suicidal behavior should not be mistaken for heroism.

The End of the Story

The Storyteller should also give out extra experience points at the end of a story, if the players have done their part and the characters have faced down substantial trials. Only a few points should be given this way, as they are effectively "bonus points" for a job well done.

One Point — Success: The characters achieved all or part of the goals they set out to accomplish. Even minor victories can be rewarded if they pushed the game forward.

One Point — Danger: The characters survived against harsh odds and grave dangers.

One Point — Wisdom: The player, and thus the character, came up with a brilliant plan or even a spontaneous strategy that enabled the troupe to survive when it would likely have failed otherwise.

More points can be awarded if the Storyteller decides they should be, or if she wants the characters to advance more quickly than they currently are.

Merits and Flaws

Merits and Flaws are Traits used to further customize characters in both advantageous and detrimental ways, adding new layers to a game. The Storyteller should agree to using these Traits — or not — before the character creation stage concludes,



Experience Point Costs



Trait	Cost
Attribute	current rating x 4
Ability	current rating x 2
New Ability	3
Art	current rating x 4
New Art	7
Realm	current rating x 3
New Realm	5
Willpower	current rating x 2
Glamour	current rating x 3



as while some Merits and Flaws adjust concepts and mechanics at a character level, others can influence the entire chronicle.

Merits and Flaws must be chosen during character creation and are purchased using freebie points. Merits have individual point costs, while Flaws generate additional freebie points. The number of Merits a character can receive is only limited by the number of freebie points a player has to spend. Characters are limited to taking up to seven points' worth of Flaws, as too many can debilitate a character to a degree where play becomes difficult. If the player takes seven points of Flaws, a character will have 22 freebie points in total at the character creation stage, to spend among the array of options detailed on p. 144 as well as on Merits.

Merits and Flaws fit into four categories: physical, mental, social, and supernatural. Physical Merits and Flaws deal with a character's appearance and physical abilities. The mental category addresses intellectual aptitudes and limitations. Social Merits and Flaws encompass the reputations and relationships changelings possess in different circles and circumstances. Otherworldly abilities possessed by changelings are covered in the supernatural category.

Storytellers are encouraged to read through the Merits and Flaws in advance of the chronicle so they can note any that may need to be restricted. Some Merits and Flaws will not fit in with all chronicles or for specific characters. Storytellers can create their own to reflect unique elements within their games, add restrictions to existing ones, or enhance them along with increasing the point value.

Physical

Acute Sense (1pt. Merit)

You have one exceptionally sharp sense: hearing, touch, smell, vision or taste. The difficulties for tasks involving the sense in question are decreased by two.